

Engagement Style by Quadrant

Day 2 · Activity 1 handout. Turns yesterday's Power × Interest placement into a default engagement style — cadence, format, length. Starting points to calibrate per stakeholder, not rigid rules.

The four engagement principles

PRINCIPLE	PLAIN ENGLISH
Engage early	Surprise = anger. Surface concerns before they become decisions.
Engage deliberately	One channel per stakeholder. Avoid the Slack-DM-plus-email-plus-meeting redundancy.
Match form to power	High-power stakeholders get crisp written updates; high-interest stakeholders get conversation.
Bidirectional asks	Every engagement names what <i>they</i> need from <i>us</i> AND what <i>we</i> need from <i>them</i> .

Most TPMs do (1) and (2) well by their second quarter in the role. (3) and (4) are the differentiators.

Engagement style by quadrant

QUADRANT	CADENCE	FORMAT	LENGTH
High Power + High Interest	Weekly or bi-weekly	Written brief + 30-min sync	Brief: 1 page; sync: focused agenda
High Power + Low Interest	Monthly or trigger-based	Crisp written update; rarely a sync	< 250 words
Low Power + High Interest	Bi-weekly	Email digest; group thread	5 bullet points
Low Power + Low Interest	Quarterly or on-launch	Newsletter / launch email	Short

These are starting points. Adjust for personality — a terse VP may want fewer words than the table implies; a nervous partner-team lead may need more contact than the quadrant suggests.

Calibration reminders

- **Crispest writing** goes to the **high-power / low-interest** quadrant — they will read 250 words, never 20 pages.
- **Group channels** (digests, threads) serve **low-power / high-interest** cohorts — engage them together, not 1:1.

- **Most of your time** should land on **high-power / high-interest** partners. If it doesn't, you're mis-investing.
- **No invented meetings.** The plan must respect calendar reality.